Grammar: Talking about the present

💡 **Big idea:** We use the **present simple** for permanent states, habits and repeated actions, and the **present continuous** for actions happening **now** or **around now**. Some verbs are **stative verbs** and we don't usually use them in the continuous form.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Use the present simple for habits and permanent states
- Use the present continuous for actions happening now
- Contrast the two tenses
- Recognise stative verbs

📖 Key words

permanent دائم	**temporary** مؤقت	**habit** عادة
at the moment في الوقت الحالي	**stative verb** فعل حالة	**contrast** يقارن

Present simple

- Permanent states: I **live** in a village in the mountains.
- Habits and repeated actions: I **hang out** with them at the weekend.
- Form: I/you/we/they **play**, he/she/it **plays**
- Negative: don't / doesn't + verb
- Question: Do / Does ... ?

Present continuous

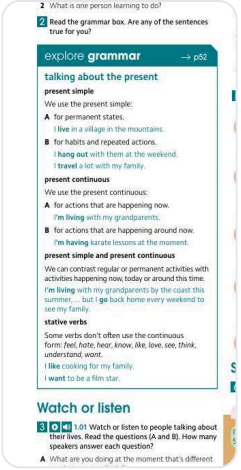
- Actions happening now: I'm **living** with my grandparents.
- Actions happening around now: I'm **having** karate lessons at the moment.
- Form: am / is / are + verb-**ing**

Present simple vs present continuous

- I'm living with my grandparents by the coast this summer, but I go back home every weekend.
- Regular = present simple, temporary = present continuous

Stative verbs

- Some verbs are not usually continuous: **feel, hate, hear, know, like, love, see, think, understand, want**
- ✓ I **like** cooking. ✓ I **want** to be a film star.
- Some can be continuous with a different meaning: I'm **thinking** about my answer (= considering).


2 What is one person learning to do?
2 Read the grammar box. Are any of the sentences true for you?
explore grammar → p52
talking about the present
present simple
We use the present simple:
A for permanent states.
I live in a village in the mountains.
B for habits and repeated actions.
I hang out with them at the weekend.
I travel a lot with my family.
present continuous
We use the present continuous:
A for actions that are happening now.
I'm living with my grandparents.
B for actions that are happening around now.
I'm having karate lessons at the moment.
present simple and present continuous
We can contrast regular or permanent activities with activities happening now, today or around this time.
I'm living with my grandparents by the coast this summer, ... but I go back home every weekend to see my family.
stative verbs
Some verbs don't often use the continuous form: feel, hate, hear, know, like, love, see, think, understand, want.
I like cooking for my family.
I want to be a film star.
Watch or listen
3 1.01 Watch or listen to people talking about their lives. Read the questions (A and B). How many speakers answer each question?
A What are you doing at the moment that's different.

Explore grammar: talking about the present

✏️ Examples

What ___ (you / do) at the moment?

Answer: are you doing

In the evenings, I usually ___ (play) football.

Answer: play

⭐ Remember

- Time words help you: always, usually, every day → present simple
- now, at the moment, this week → present continuous

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ I am knowing the answer. ✓ I know the answer.
- ✗ She go to school every day. ✓ She goes to school every day.

🧩 **Activity:** Tell your partner a few things about yourself that they might not know (I'm learning to speak Spanish at the moment...)

✅ Check yourself

1. Which tense for habits?
2. Form of present continuous?
3. Is know a stative verb?

Answers: (1) present simple ، (2) am/is/are + verb-ing ، (3) yes